

Simin Tong

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Exoplanetary systems, protoplanetary disks, planet formation, multi-wavelength disk observations, disk modelling, disk chemistry.

EMPLOYMENT

University of Michigan

Research Fellow

Advisor: Prof. Edwin Bergin

Ann Arbor, US

Oct. 2026-

EDUCATION

University of Leicester

Ph.D., Astronomy

Advisor: Prof. Richard Alexander

Leicester, UK

Sept. 2022- Sept. 2026

Leiden University

M.Sc. (cum laude), Astronomy

Advisor: Dr. Nienke van der Marel

Leiden, Netherlands

Sept. 2019- Aug.2022

Jilin University

B.Sc., Physics and LL.B., Law

Jilin, China

Sept. 2015 -Jun. 2019

SCHOLARSHIPS & AWARDS

- Student award from the Great Britain China Educational Trust ([charity no.269944](#)) 2026
- DAAD Research Grant 2026
 - Competitive 6-month grant supporting independent research.
- Leicester Future 100 Studentship *Sept. 2022-Mar. 2026*
- Leiden International Tuition Fee Waiver 2020-2022
- Dean's Scholarship 2019
 - the highest honour for undergraduates at the Department of Physics, JLU
- Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award 2019
- Outstanding Graduate in Jilin University 2019
- University Scholarship 2016-2019

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

Research visits

- Research visit to MPIA @Heidelberg, Germany (Host: Prof. Myriam Benisty) *Jan.-Jun., 2026*
- Kavli Summer Program in Astrophysics 2025 @VA, US *Jun.-Aug., 2025*
- Secondment to SUNY, Stony Brook @NY, US (Host: Prof. Phil Armitage) *Apr.-Jul., 2024*
- Summer Student at ASIAA @Taipei *Jul.-Aug., 2019*
- Summer Student at Shanghai Astronomical Observatory @Shanghai, China *Jul. 2017&2018*

Summer/Winter schools

- Global Astrochemistry Lecture Series (GALS) 2025 ([Online](#)) Feb.–Apr., 2025
- EXOHOST Summer School @Tartu, Estonia Sept., 2024
- DUSTBUSTERS Winter School II @Lyon, France Jan., 2024
- Disc and Planet Formation Summer School @Beijing, China (virtual) Jul., 2022
- The 4th SKA Summer School @Shanghai, China Jul. 2018

PUBLICATIONS

 [Full list](#)  [First author list](#)

First-author:

4. **Tong**, van der Marel, Williams & Anderson (2026) Disk survey in the Serpens star-forming region: environmental effects in nearby star-forming regions (*Accepted to A&A*) [[ADS](#)]
3. **Tong**, Alexander & Rosotti (2026) Turbulence and dust fragility in protoplanetary discs. MNRAS, 545(4), staf2128 [[ADS](#)]
2. **Tong** & Alexander (2025) Compact protoplanetary discs can be produced by dead zones. MNRAS, 537(4), 3525 [[ADS](#)]
1. **Tong**, Alexander & Rosotti (2024) A question of personalities: evolution of viscous and wind-driven protoplanetary discs in the presence of dead zones. MNRAS, 533(2), 1211 [[ADS](#)]

Other contributions:

- Anderson et al. (2022) (incl. **Tong**) Protostellar and protoplanetary disk masses in the Serpens region. ApJ, 938(1), 55. [[ADS](#)]

TALKS & SEMINARS

22. DISCO @VA, US (virtual) Sept., 2026
21. Discs on the Exe @Exeter, UK  Jul., 2026
20. UKI Discs Meeting 2026 @Cambridge, UK  Jul., 2026
19. Group Meeting at MPIA @Heidelberg, Germany Mar., 2026
18. Hydrodynamic and Dusty Turbulence in Protoplanetary Disks @NY, US Feb., 2026
17. Planet Formation & Exoplanets Coffee, MPIA @Heidelberg, Germany Feb., 2026
16. Monday Science Seminar at UW-Madison @WI, US (virtual) Oct., 2025
15. UKI Discs Meeting 2025 @Hatfield, UK  Sept., 2025
14. Kavil Summer School 2025 @VA, US Aug., 2025
13. Group Meeting at QMUL @London, UK May, 2025
12. Midland Discs Meeting @Warwick, UK May, 2025
11. Pebbles in Planet Formation @Tokyo, Japan(virtual)  Feb., 2025
10. Group Meeting at MPIA @Heidelberg, Germany (virtual) Feb., 2025
9. Seminar at Purple Mountain Observatory @Nanjing, China Dec., 2024

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| 8. Group Meeting at Zhejiang University @Hangzhou, China | Dec., 2024 |
| 7. Seminar at Shanghai Astronomical Observatory @Shanghai, China | Dec., 2024 |
| 6. PDS Seminar at Tsinghua University @Beijing, China | Dec., 2024 |
| 5. Kavli Institute of Astronomy and Astrophysics Seminar @Beijing, China | Dec., 2024 |
| 4. UKI Discs Meeting @Warwick, UK  | Sept., 2024 |
| 3. COST Action Kick-off Meeting @Torun, Poland  | Jul., 2024 |
| 2. Group Meeting at the CCA, Flatiron Institute @NY, US | May, 2024 |
| 1. Midland Discs Meeting @Leicester, UK  | Jun., 2023 |

POSTERS

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| 4. Gordon Research Conference, Origins of Solar Systems @MA, US  | Jun., 2025 |
| 3. New Heights in Planet Formation @Garching, Germany  | Jul., 2024 |
| 2. National Astronomy Meeting 2023 @Cardiff, UK  | Jul., 2023 |
| 1. Protostars and Planets VII @Kyoto, Japan  | Apr., 2023 |

MENTORING & OUTREACH

- Mentored **5** secondary school and undergraduate students from diverse backgrounds on astronomy projects.
- Advised and supported **10+** undergraduate students in preparing graduate school applications.
- Coordinated and contributed to the EN-CN translation of the citizen science project Radio Galaxy Zoo: LOFAR on Zooniverse, expanding accessibility to Chinese-speaking participants. 
- Shared my experience as a female astronomer at 2 secondary schools in a developing country to inspire younger students, particularly girls, to pursue STEM.
- Shared 15+ worldwide fellowship opportunities for early-career researchers on Chinese social media, generating over 2,300 likes, saves, and shares.
- Compiled astronomy-related summer programs for *high-school students* worldwide. 
- Built a tool to assess colour-scheme accessibility for people with colour vision deficiencies and distinguishability in B&W print. 

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- **Programming&tools:**
 - Languages: PYTHON, FORTRAN, C, HTML&CSS
 - Professional tools/packages: DustPy, CASA, RADMC-3D, ProDiMo, astropy, FARGO3D
- **Languages:** English (Professional); Mandarin (Native)